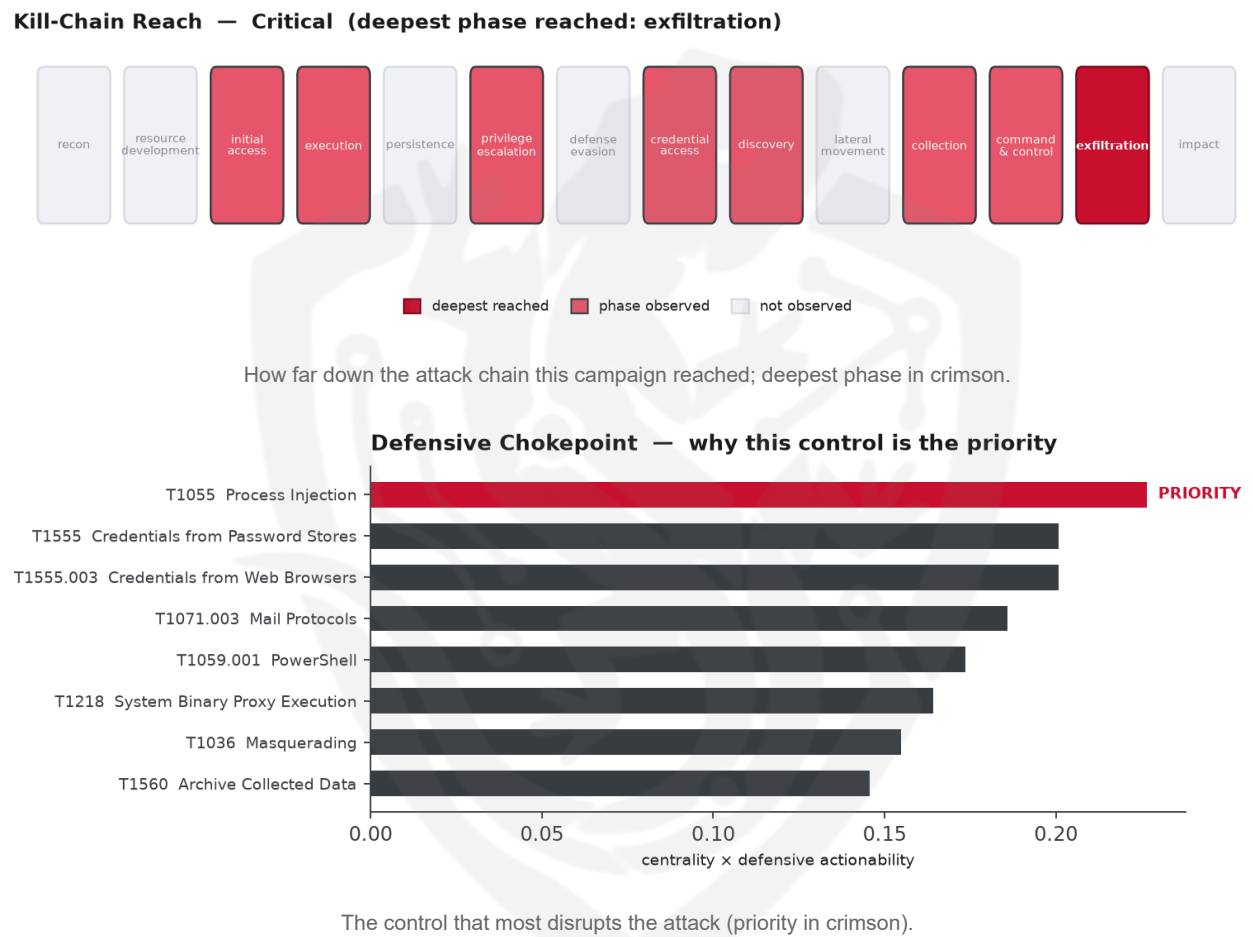


THREAT REPORT: UNKNOWN_ADVERSARY

PHANTOM STEALER CAMPAIGN

Visual Summary



Summary

The observed cluster of activity has been identified as a multi-stage Phantom Stealer campaign, targeting entities in Malaysia, particularly in the finance and government sectors. The campaign involves various techniques to steal sensitive information. Priority should be given to detecting and preventing process injection, as it is the identified chokepoint in the attack chain. The threat actor's use of Phantom Stealer malware poses a significant risk to the targeted organizations.

Threat Overview

The threat actor, whose identity is currently unknown, is utilizing the Phantom Stealer malware family to exploit vulnerabilities in targeted systems. Although the central CVE is not specified, the actor is leveraging a range of techniques, including JavaScript and PowerShell, to facilitate the attack. The

primary targets of this campaign are organizations in Malaysia, specifically those in the finance and government sectors.

Attack Chain and Priority Control

The attack chain involves a series of techniques, including spearphishing, system information discovery, and data exfiltration. The priority technique in this chain is T1055 Process Injection, which is the identified graph chokepoint. To mitigate this threat, the priority control is to Enable EDR detection of process injection (CreateRemoteThread, hollowing); alert on cross-process memory writes.

Infrastructure and Corroboration

There is currently no available information on the hosting providers or ASNs observed in this campaign. Additionally, no malware families have been corroborated by abuse.ch, and no indicators have been flagged with a confidence level of 80% or higher by AbuseIPDB, with the highest confidence seen being 0%.

Technical Appendix

Ground-truth telemetry from the source pulse; analytical scores are secondary and clearly labelled.

Observed Techniques (ATT&CK, expert-tagged by source)

- T1059.007 JavaScript
- T1566.001 Spearphishing Attachment
- T1082 System Information Discovery
- T1005 Data from Local System
- T1140 Deobfuscate/Decode Files or Information
- T1555 Credentials from Password Stores
- T1036 Masquerading
- T1055 Process Injection
- T1218 System Binary Proxy Execution
- T1560 Archive Collected Data
- T1071.003 Mail Protocols
- T1555.003 Credentials from Web Browsers
- T1057 Process Discovery
- T1059.001 PowerShell
- T1048 Exfiltration Over Alternative Protocol
- T1027 Obfuscated Files or Information
- T1573 Encrypted Channel

Analytical Scores

- Priority technique (graph chokepoint): T1055 Process Injection (centrality 0.3235).

- Operational risk: Critical (score 0.968, reaches exfiltration).

Behavioral Signature Cluster

- Method: technique-overlap cosine vs 170 MITRE ATT&CK Groups (top overlap 0.4985; reference threshold $\tau = 0.6$).
- These are behavioural resemblances for defensive playbook cross-referencing, not an identity assessment. Where the source pulse names an actor, that attribution is authoritative; the overlaps below neither confirm nor contest it.

Nearest historical profiles by behavioural overlap (resemblance only):

Historical Profile	Behavioural Overlap
Inception	0.4985
Molerats	0.4919
Malteiro	0.4617
Stealth Falcon	0.4617
APT37	0.4243

Enrichment Signal

- Highest AbuseIPDB confidence among IOCs: 0%.

Indicators of Compromise (defanged — non-clickable)

The network and file indicators observed in this activity are listed below for blocklisting:

Type	Indicator
Hash	34bfa888695b9aaa41bd575245972043
Hash	5f238710a5ef4f6ddbbe7a118c822705
Hash	6bbfc88534d5d515dddb0ec9bb618530
Hash	8a620e451e64f418bc21fd458e952f2e
Hash	a30b628d0c087f305b35be3e3f5281b3
Hash	ddb91e512fa3ae6a38eed741868526ffbc40a864
Hash	64a68e4e1b93f1347c0935875395672784db5b49027c6508f13983efa98971f8

Flame Cell // Adversary Pivot [BETA]

BETA. A hypothetical tabletop projection, anchored to documented ATT&CK behaviour and technique co-occurrence across 170 tracked groups. It is not a prediction; treat it as a war-game prompt and review before acting. Spot a pivot that looks wrong? norbert@salacti.com

- **Control applied:** T1055 Process Injection (privilege-escalation)
- **Observed here:** T1055 Process Injection was the only privilege-escalation technique observed in this campaign, so the pivot is projected from cross-actor behaviour.
- **Projected pivot:** T1053 Scheduled Task/Job (privilege-escalation)
- **Basis:** 19 of 170 documented groups that use Process Injection also use Scheduled Task/Job (conditional 0.63, lift 1.9, i.e. ~1.9x base rate). Strongest same-tactic neighbour.

The actor could pivot to using T1053 Scheduled Task/Job to maintain persistence and execute malicious code, potentially by scheduling a task to run at a specific interval, which may allow them to bypass the blocked process injection technique. This approach would likely involve creating a new scheduled task that appears legitimate, in an attempt to evade detection. The defensive control to counter this potential move is to alert on new scheduled tasks (Event ID 4698); restrict schtasks/at to admins; baseline legitimate task creators.

Also plausible (same tactic): T1547 Boot or Logon Autostart Execution (n=19, lift 1.9), T1078 Valid Accounts (n=16, lift 1.4)

Detection and hardening for the pivot (T1053 Scheduled Task/Job)

- **Telemetry:** Windows Security (Object Access audit); Microsoft-Windows-TaskScheduler/Operational; Sysmon
- **Detect:**
 - Security 4698 (task created), 4702 (updated), 4700/4701 (enabled/disabled), 4699 (deleted)
 - TaskScheduler/Operational 106 (registered), 140 (updated), 141 (deleted)
 - Sysmon 1 for schtasks.exe and at.exe; Sysmon 11 for writes under C:\Windows\System32\Tasks\
- **Harden:**
 - Restrict schtasks/at to administrators; disable the legacy at.exe
 - Baseline the legitimate task creators and alert on anything outside it
- **MITRE:** M1047 Audit, M1028 Operating System Configuration, M1026 Privileged Account Management · DS0003 Scheduled Job, DS0009 Process, DS0022 File